

Ὁ περίπλους Ἄννωνος τοῦ Ναυάρχου

The Periplus of Hanno the Navigator

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Period: Κλασική [Classical](#)
Dialect: Κοινή τεχνική [Technical Koine](#)
Domain: Γεωγραφία [Geography](#)
Format: Πεζός [Prose](#)

Voyage of Hanno the Navigator

Life

No biographical details survive for the anonymous Greek translator of the Periplus of Hanno. The text is a Greek adaptation of a Punic inscription that recorded the expedition of the Carthaginian magistrate and explorer Hanno, who navigated the Atlantic coast of Africa in the sixth or fifth century BCE. The original was displayed in the temple of Ba'al Hammon in Carthage. The work's existence demonstrates cultural transmission between the Punic and Greek worlds.

Works

The Periplus of Hanno is a concise prose account of a Carthaginian voyage along northwestern Africa, representing the sole surviving work of this tradition.

Significance

The Periplus is a historical document of primary importance, offering a rare firsthand glimpse into Carthaginian maritime exploration and Atlantic colonization. Its descriptions of indigenous peoples, wildlife, and volcanic phenomena have provoked extensive scholarly analysis regarding their identification and the journey's southern limit. As a Greek translation of a lost Punic original, it is crucial evidence for cross-cultural knowledge exchange and a definitive example of the ancient periplus genre.

Works (1)

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